

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
AGENCIES, SYSTEMS, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL
FILING OR CYBERSECURITY GUIDE**

Public Redacted DOE Cross-Motion and Opposition

Filed: October 27, 2025 **Synthetic docket:** SYN-DMD-25-CV-0914 **Counsel:** Corin Pell,
fictional counsel for DOE

The fictional United States Department of Energy cross-moves for summary judgment and opposes Open Grid Archive’s motion. DOE contends that its declarations, Vaughn submissions, paired samples, and controlled in-camera materials establish the disputed applications of Exemptions 7(E) and 7(F), the release of all reasonably segregable text, and the need to maintain restricted access to the sealed counterparts.

The agency does not ask the Court to infer protection merely from the phrase “cyber response.” It relies on the relationships represented publicly by [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DECISION CONDITION], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL RESPONSE ORDER], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL ESCALATION VALUE], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DUTY ROLE], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL SAFETY REFERENCE], and [REDACTED—FICTIONAL CONTACT CHANNEL]. The filing contains no operational content.

DOE also notes that it voluntarily conducted a supplemental review. That effort did not locate another responsive record, but it released seventeen passages on eleven replacement images. DOE submits that the correction demonstrates a functioning segregation process rather than a defect requiring another review.

The Court should deny Open Grid’s motion, grant DOE’s cross-motion, and enter judgment on the complete fictional record. Any inspection of controlled labels should occur without expanding public access beyond the paired redacted filings.

Procedural History

Open Grid submitted request DOE-FOIA-2024-OG-041 on June 3, 2024. After questions and written narrowing, the scope became final on June 21 under CLR-OG-0621. ORER searched the preserved fictional repositories, issued initial decision RLS-OG-001 on August 16, and defended that decision through the administrative appeal resolved by FAD-OG-1007 on October 7.

Open Grid filed this action on April 7, 2025. DOE answered on May 5. On August 4, DOE filed processing, custody, and search declarations with a public and controlled Vaughn presentation. A supplemental search and review followed, producing RLS-OG-002 and revised explanations on September 8.

The parties then submitted paired sample records so the Court could compare public notices with inert controlled labels. The samples reproduce semantic field types without disclosing real information. They are evidentiary illustrations, not additional responsive agency records.

DOE maintains that the search is adequate and understands Open Grid not to seek further collection discovery on this motion. The contested questions concern exemption fit, reasonably segregable portions, and judicial access. Those issues are suitable for resolution from the declarations, indexes, samples, and the Court's in-camera review.

Responsive-Universe Accounting

The agreed search boundary yielded twelve responsive records and 200 logical source pages. Four decision-tree records total sixty pages. Three escalation matrices total fifty-four pages. Three coordination appendices total sixty-four pages. Two governance instruments total twenty-two pages.

DOE withheld GS-DT-4.2, GS-DT-3.7, and GS-EM-4.2 in full, accounting for three records and fifty-four pages. Seven other playbook records and their 124 pages were released with redactions. GS-GV-04 and GS-GV-03, totaling twenty-two pages, were released in full. The original production therefore contained 146 images.

Sixty-eight produced images carried no blackout. Seventy-eight contained one or more redactions. Exemption 7(E) appeared on sixty-two of those images, Exemption 7(F) on fifty-one, and both exemptions on thirty-five. Every completely withheld page relied on 7(E); thirty-nine of the fifty-four also relied on 7(F).

The later release of seventeen passages did not change these source totals. It replaced eleven already-produced images, with two new passages on six images and one on five. Public and sealed court twins likewise do not increase the responsive universe because they are litigation presentations of underlying semantic segments.

FOIA Standards Applied to This Record

DOE bears the burden of establishing the exemptions and agrees that review is de novo. Declarations are sufficient when reasonably detailed, submitted in good faith, and not contradicted by evidence in the record. A Vaughn index may organize [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DECISION CONDITION], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL RESPONSE ORDER], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL ESCALATION VALUE], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DUTY ROLE], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL SAFETY REFERENCE], and [REDACTED—FICTIONAL CONTACT CHANNEL] by function when the categories derive from document review and permit assessment of predicted harm.

Exemption 7(E) reaches law-enforcement techniques and procedures and also guidelines whose disclosure could reasonably be expected to risk circumvention. The agency need not show that a technique is entirely unknown; implementation detail may remain protected even when the general method is familiar.

Exemption 7(F) applies where disclosure could reasonably be expected to endanger an individual's life or physical safety. Identification of a threatened person by name is not required. A category can satisfy the exemption if the agency explains how disclosure of that functional type creates the expected danger.

Segregability requires release of meaningful nonexempt portions. It does not require disclosure of fragments that would reveal an exempt relationship through placement or that would have no informational content after necessary removal. The declarations describe the review that DOE says it performed under that standard.

Qualifying Law-Enforcement Purpose

The operational playbooks were compiled and used within the fictional Grid Sentinel program to prevent, recognize, and coordinate responses to unlawful attacks. That purpose falls within Exemption 7's threshold. It is not based solely on DOE's general mission or the repository where the documents were stored.

The distinction between playbooks and governance records supports the asserted purpose. DOE released the two approval and supersession instruments because they document publication decisions rather than organize a protective response. It withheld or redacted operational records according to the functions described in the indexes.

The clarified request excluded actual incident material, technical configurations, source code, credentials, access-control data, and real-infrastructure diagrams. That narrowing does not remove the protective purpose from final operational frameworks. A record can concern how a response is organized without containing event-specific data.

Open Grid accepts the threshold for purposes of its motion but argues about scope. DOE agrees that each subpart must still be satisfied. The threshold supplies context for [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DECISION CONDITION], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL RESPONSE ORDER], and [REDACTED—FICTIONAL ESCALATION VALUE] types without itself proving their protection.

Exemption 7(E) and Nonpublic Organization

The decision-tree records connect [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DECISION CONDITION] with [REDACTED—FICTIONAL RESPONSE ORDER]. DOE contends that disclosure of those relationships would expose the nonpublic implementation of a protective technique. General awareness that agencies use triage does not reveal how this approved fictional edition organizes its choices.

The escalation records contain [REDACTED—FICTIONAL ESCALATION VALUE] fields that DOE treats as guidelines. The declarations predict that revealing the relevant classification relationships could allow a hypothetical actor to anticipate when the framework changes state, risking circumvention. The public tokens do not reveal a value or relationship.

DOE also withheld contextual material where a heading or placement would disclose how protected elements relate. It released edition titles, general purposes, and administrative text when reviewers concluded those propositions stood independently. The line is functional rather than based on the visual size of a blackout.

The three completely withheld records concentrate the protected relationships throughout their structures. DOE asserts that isolated headings from those documents would either expose organization or convey no useful information. The Court may confirm that conclusion through the controlled samples and in-camera submission without public disclosure.

Exemption 7(F) Functional Categories

DOE grouped certain fields as duty assignments, safety references, and controlled communication categories. Their public markers are [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DUTY ROLE], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL SAFETY REFERENCE], and [REDACTED—FICTIONAL CONTACT CHANNEL]. The categories were identified during document review rather than imposed solely by title.

The asserted harm is interference with a protective human function. DOE explains that disclosure of the relationship between an assigned function, a safety classification, and a coordination category could permit a person to focus disruption on those responsible for protective activity. The agency need not identify a particular individual for that risk to fall within 7(F).

The escalation-matrix sample places the role and safety types in corresponding semantic fields. It omits every real identity, danger, measure, and contact detail. DOE relies on that safe illustration to show the function of the category while preventing disclosure of the underlying relationship.

Open Grid characterizes the explanation as too broad because some labels appear near administrative text. DOE responds that the exemption attaches to the functional relationship, not to the label in isolation, and that reviewers released surrounding material whenever it could be detached without exposing that relationship.

Record-Family Application of 7(F)

In the decision-tree family, DOE applied 7(F) where [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DUTY ROLE] or [REDACTED—FICTIONAL SAFETY REFERENCE] fields were integrated with response organization. In the escalation-matrix family, it applied the exemption where those classifications appeared together or where [REDACTED—FICTIONAL CONTACT CHANNEL] was linked to a protective assignment. In the coordination appendices, its use was narrower.

Those categories share a predicted harm but not necessarily identical language. DOE's Vaughn materials describe the records individually and then use the functional group to avoid repeating a safety explanation that would disclose context through needless detail. The category is intended to be both reviewable and protective.

The seventh semantic division of these paired memoranda summarizes DOE's position: the Court should evaluate whether the category arose from record review, whether the identified function is coherent, and whether disclosure of the relationship could reasonably be expected to endanger a person. DOE submits that its declarations answer each question.

The agency does not claim that every reference to administration is a 7(F) field. It relies on the public releases and the seventeen later passages as evidence that neutral text was separated. The remaining disputes concern relationships DOE says cannot be exposed safely.

Treatment of the Three Playbook Families

GS-DT-4.2 and GS-DT-3.7 are densely organized decision frameworks. DOE withheld all eighteen pages of the first and all sixteen pages of the second because [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DECISION CONDITION] and [REDACTED—FICTIONAL RESPONSE ORDER] relationships organize them. [REDACTED—FICTIONAL ESCALATION VALUE], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DUTY ROLE], and [REDACTED—FICTIONAL SAFETY REFERENCE] also appear in asserted categories. Comparing editions would compound the disclosure.

GS-DT-T1 and GS-DT-QA were partially produced because exercise status, quality-review administration, revision history, and several headings could be separated. Operational relationships remained withheld. The supplemental release added further neutral language from those records.

GS-EM-4.2, twenty pages, was withheld in full because its classification relationships permeate the document. GS-EM-3.7 and GS-EM-T1 were partially released. DOE applied 7(F) where the described human-safety functions appeared and 7(E) where classification guidelines remained nonpublic.

The three coordination appendices received partial release. General publication, archival, and coordination descriptions were produced; asserted role, safety, or channel relationships were redacted. The two governance instruments were fully disclosed. DOE contends that this variation demonstrates content-specific treatment rather than a program-wide presumption.

Segregability and the Supplemental Review

Elian Voss and Kira Morrow describe review of each responsive page for independently meaningful text. Reviewers considered whether a sentence expressed administration, whether its position revealed a protected relation, whether a heading remained intelligible without subordinate detail, and whether neutral language could be detached from [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DUTY ROLE], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL SAFETY REFERENCE], or [REDACTED—FICTIONAL CONTACT CHANNEL].

The later review cleared seventeen passages on eleven images. Six images gained two passages and five gained one. Released text addressed review ownership, general headings, approval status, edition history, archival direction, and high-level coordination. The source set remained twelve records and 200 pages.

DOE submits that willingness to correct the production supports, rather than undermines, its final segregation determination. The supplemental process applied a refined protocol and produced text when the protected relationship could remain concealed. It retained other passages after concluding that removal would either expose placement or leave meaningless fragments.

FOIA requires reasonable segregation, not perfection on the first pass. DOE argues that the operative question is whether the record now shows a careful review and release of all coherent nonexempt matter. Its declarations, worksheets, and paired exhibits provide that showing.

Entirely Withheld Records

DOE recognizes that withholding a complete document requires particular care. The two decision trees and current matrix are structured around [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DECISION CONDITION], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL RESPONSE ORDER], and [REDACTED—FICTIONAL ESCALATION VALUE] relationships rather than discrete appendices containing separable narrative. Their order, headings, and adjacency carry asserted implementation information.

Reviewers tested cover material, revision blocks, captions, and fragments. They concluded that information already available elsewhere, such as title and edition date, was disclosed through the Vaughn indexes and governance records. Repeating those facts as isolated excerpts would add no meaningful information. Other proposed excerpts would disclose organization through their position.

The controlled in-camera presentation allows the Court to verify those conclusions. It uses inert labels to describe the types safely and does not ask the Court to rely on an unseen assertion alone. DOE nevertheless maintains restricted access because the semantic relationships, rather than the invented words, are the focus of the claimed exemptions.

Open Grid seeks a renewed line review. DOE argues that another pass would repeat the completed analysis and risk requiring release of either noninformative fragments or context that reveals the withheld arrangement.

Sealed Judicial Materials

DOE filed a consolidated public motion identifying the controlled materials, the interests asserted, alternatives considered, and proposed duration. Public counterparts exist for every sealed twin. The controlled exhibits are limited to the inert labels and semantic relationships needed for review.

DOE considered line redaction within the controlled filings but concluded that repeated removals would prevent the Court from evaluating the claimed relationships. It considered filing only a declaration, but that alternative would deprive the Court of page correspondence. Paired counterparts permit public understanding of the dispute while preserving the controlled presentation.

The agency requests sealing through final resolution of this action and any appeal, subject to later motion or court order. It does not seek to close the docket, the public motions, or the public versions of exhibits. Notice has been provided through the open motion.

DOE acknowledges that the Court must make findings. It submits that the common fictional program context, the defined field categories, and the need for semantic comparison support maintaining the controlled set together. The request is directed to these identified twins, not to unrelated filings.

Conclusion

DOE respectfully asks the Court to grant its cross-motion. It has addressed [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DECISION CONDITION], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL RESPONSE ORDER], and [REDACTED—FICTIONAL ESCALATION VALUE] under 7(E), linked [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DUTY ROLE], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL SAFETY REFERENCE], and [REDACTED—FICTIONAL CONTACT CHANNEL] to 7(F), and released all meaningful segregable information after supplemental review.

The record accounts for every one of the twelve responsive documents and 200 pages. It explains the three complete withholdings, seven partial productions, two full releases, and the seventeen later passages without changing the source universe. No genuine operational information is necessary to adjudicate those claims.

DOE also asks the Court to maintain the controlled counterparts under seal for the stated litigation duration while leaving the independently worded public copies accessible. The paired procedure is the least restrictive means that preserves useful judicial comparison on this synthetic record.

Corin Pell certifies service on Tamsin Roe and Leo Marr through the fictional docket on October 27, 2025. This filing contains only approved public notices and no real cyber instruction, identity, or infrastructure detail.